Market Brief - offline copy

Snapshot taken Sunday 18 October 2026, 18:54 (Europe/Madrid). Data is frozen at that time. Links open the original articles when you are online.

Daily overview

Markets over the last day: the eight tracked equity indices moved +0.03% on average, with Nikkei 225 strongest (+1.39%) and Nasdaq weakest (-2.15%). Brent crude changed +3.72% to 109.86. Gold changed +0.26% to 4,181.1001. Bitcoin changed -0.53% to 80,952.1797. The US 10-year yield stands at 5.098%, a relative move of +0.18%. Among the firms tracked, Equinor (+4.59%) and BP (+3.65%) moved the most.

Deals and capital markets: Listings in south-east Asia gain momentum with $1bn IPO (FT Markets). Owner of digital wallet GCash set to start trading in region’s biggest debut this year Central banks and macro: BoE’s Bailey tells G30 they ‘have got to address’ AI agent concerns (FT Markets). Central Bank governor warns rapid development of AI is a major issue for financial stability Geopolitics and trade: Trump exempts Russia from further sanctions mandated by new law (FT Markets). US president gives Putin a reprieve on threatened energy measures after cutting deal with Moscow to release diesel Geopolitics and trade: Saudi helicopter crash kills two troops near Yemen border (FT World). First reported military fatalities for the kingdom come as war with Houthi rebels continues to escalate Also ranking highly: St Petersburg endures biggest Ukrainian drone attack (FT World). Strikes hit tech infrastructure after Russia targets electricity substations in Ukraine

Weekly overview

Markets over the past seven days: the eight tracked equity indices moved -0.69% on average, with FTSE 100 strongest (+3.13%) and Nikkei 225 weakest (-5.38%). Brent crude changed +4.91% to 109.86. Gold changed -0.83% to 4,181.1001. Bitcoin changed -2.58% to 80,952.1797. The US 10-year yield stands at 5.098%, a relative move of -2.78%. Among the firms tracked, ConocoPhillips (+9.25%) and Equinor (+9.23%) moved the most.

Deals and capital markets: Credit Suisse bankers denied bonuses stripped after UBS takeover (FT World). Switzerland’s top court sides with government decision, overturning ruling of lower court Deals and capital markets: India approves biggest foreign takeover of domestic bank (FT Companies). Canada’s Fairfax Financial Holdings to buy nearly 61% of IDBI Bank for $5.6bn Central banks and macro: US inflation jumps to 3.7% as Iran war drives up prices (FT World). Rebound in fuel costs has piled pressure on voters ahead of midterm elections Central banks and macro: Trump has failed to listen to voters on inflation (FT World). People elect presidents to fix problems, not to diagnose their causes Geopolitics and trade: How will Big Oil spend its $32bn Iran war windfall? (FT Markets). Investors are keen to see how the world’s largest crude companies plan to deploy extra cash generated by soaring energy prices

Major news by sector (past 7 days)

IPOs & Listings

Listings in south-east Asia gain momentum with $1bn IPO

FT Markets | 18 Oct 03:00

Owner of digital wallet GCash set to start trading in region’s biggest debut this year

The data centre IPO debacle that sparked a market meltdown

FT Markets | 16 Oct 06:54

Decisions by Australian groups Firmus and AirTrunk have added to concerns about the AI borrowing frenzy

General Atlantic’s IPO ambitions

FT Markets | 15 Oct 06:00

The private capital group is planning to go public in the first half of next year as it seeks to keep pace with listed rivals like Blackstone and Apollo Global

General Atlantic plans IPO at up to $10bn valuation

FT Markets | 14 Oct 12:00

Private capital group looks to fund ambitious expansion plan to keep pace with rivals Blackstone and Apollo Global

What a $30bn Aussie data centre IPO debacle actually means

FT Markets | 12 Oct 07:00

Misery, thy name is pulled IPO

M&A & Deals

Credit Suisse bankers denied bonuses stripped after UBS takeover

FT World | 15 Oct 13:46

Switzerland’s top court sides with government decision, overturning ruling of lower court

India approves biggest foreign takeover of domestic bank

FT Companies | 15 Oct 09:19

Canada’s Fairfax Financial Holdings to buy nearly 61% of IDBI Bank for $5.6bn

CVC sought to hush Israel defence deal to avoid controversy

FT Markets | 12 Oct 06:00

Private equity firm made unusual decision not to announce its acquisition of a 40% stake in camouflage maker Fibrotex

Private equity puts string of UK high street names up for sale

FT Markets | 12 Oct 13:00

Owners of PizzaExpress, Morrisons and Itsu seeking exits as buyout groups cool on sector

Thames Water’s senior creditors near deal with rivals to avoid court challenge

FT World | 15 Oct 16:16

Bondholders set to grant slice of equity to junior creditors to smooth path of utility takeover

Nandy 'minded to intervene' in Sky's £1.6bn takeover of ITV entertainment arm

BBC Business | 15 Oct 16:55

The culture secretary says the deal could affect free expression in the media and the variety of Britain's news landscape.

Private Equity, VC & Angels

Olympus shares suffer biggest drop since 2011 after FDA warning

FT Companies | 14 Oct 09:24

Japanese medical devices maker tumbles 13.5% as private equity circles company

Private equity interest endangers London float of former DS Smith business

FT Markets | 15 Oct 15:13

Lone Star and Atlas Holdings consider offers after owner International Paper announced plans to float the division in London

Asset Management

BlackRock pulls in $205bn to take assets to record high

FT Markets | 14 Oct 13:39

World’s largest asset manager has become an increasingly powerful force in private capital after acquisitions of HPS and Global Infrastructure Partners

Central Banks & Macro

US inflation jumps to 3.7% as Iran war drives up prices

FT World | 14 Oct 18:18

Rebound in fuel costs has piled pressure on voters ahead of midterm elections

Trump has failed to listen to voters on inflation

FT World | 16 Oct 16:58

People elect presidents to fix problems, not to diagnose their causes

‘Early days’ to see full effect of energy prices on inflation, BoE’s Bailey says

FT World | 16 Oct 05:12

Lengthy period of higher costs would squeeze corporate margins and spur some companies to raise prices

Rising inflation piles pressure on US voters ahead of midterm elections

FT World | 15 Oct 15:00

Also in today’s newsletter, are Democrats developing an advantage among independent voters?

US inflation again set to be a crucial factor for the midterms

FT World | 15 Oct 06:30

Donald Trump was re-elected on the back of inflation anger, and his party is now in danger of losing control of the House and Senate for the same reason

US chip stocks slide as inflation and AI debt fears unsettle investors

FT Markets | 14 Oct 22:36

Investors rush into Treasuries as sell-off triggers demand for haven assets

Geopolitics & Trade

How will Big Oil spend its $32bn Iran war windfall?

FT Markets | 15 Oct 06:00

Investors are keen to see how the world’s largest crude companies plan to deploy extra cash generated by soaring energy prices

EU vows to maintain Russia sanctions after US pivot

FT World | 16 Oct 17:46

European leaders close ranks around Volodymyr Zelenskyy following Donald Trump’s fuel deal with Moscow

Gulf oil production rebounds ahead of increase in Iran war hostilities

FT Markets | 13 Oct 14:53

Saudi Arabia says output in September hit highest level since start of conflict, though revival now at risk from renewed attacks on shipping this month

Trump exempts Russia from further sanctions mandated by new law

FT Markets | 17 Oct 11:53

US president gives Putin a reprieve on threatened energy measures after cutting deal with Moscow to release diesel

Are we sleepwalking into World War III?

FT World | 17 Oct 06:00

As regional conflicts rage and revisionist powers challenge the established order, warnings of a new global conflagration are growing louder

Who’s winning the trade war with China? You asked, we answered

FT World | 15 Oct 14:00

Senior trade writer Alan Beattie and economics columnist Soumaya Keynes replied to reader questions

Commodities & Energy

Investors predict new record price for gold within two years

FT Markets | 15 Oct 06:00

Central banks in September made their highest monthly purchases of the precious metal for almost two years

Ship attack reports near Hormuz reach record high as oil exports slow

BBC Business | 16 Oct 07:00

BBC Verify analysis of data from a UK maritime agency shows 12 vessels were struck in a week.

Markets

Equities	Last	Day	Week
S&P 500	7,659.4399	-1.09%	-1.95%
Nasdaq	26,140.0293	-2.15%	-4.48%
Dow Jones	52,002.4102	-0.34%	+0.67%
FTSE 100	10,881.9004	+0.38%	+3.13%
DAX	25,622.6094	+0.95%	+2.13%
Nikkei 225	65,324.2891	+1.39%	-5.38%
Hang Seng	24,186.8301	+0.52%	-0.10%
Euro Stoxx 50	6,204.23	+0.58%	+0.50%

Currencies	Last	Day	Week
EUR/USD	1.1242	+0.26%	+0.33%
GBP/USD	1.3329	+0.42%	+0.66%
USD/JPY	157.987	+0.02%	-0.05%
USD/CNY	6.6768	-0.21%	-0.23%

Bonds	Last	Day	Week
US 5Y yield	4.899	+0.00%	-2.43%
US 10Y yield	5.098	+0.18%	-2.78%
US 30Y yield	5.436	+0.13%	-2.93%

Financial sector	Last	Day	Week
US Financials (XLF)	55.52	+0.45%	+1.44%
US Banks (KBE)	63.62	+0.11%	+0.78%
Europe Financials (EUFN)	38.72	-0.28%	+0.91%

Energy	Last	Day	Week
Brent crude	109.86	+3.72%	+4.91%
WTI crude	99.02	+1.07%	+7.81%
Natural gas	3.116	-3.71%	-3.23%

Metals	Last	Day	Week

Gold	4,181.1001	+0.26%	-0.83%
Silver	57.305	+0.82%	-5.55%
Copper	6.5735	+0.95%	-1.04%

Agriculture	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
Wheat	660.5	-1.42%	-1.56%
Corn	474.25	-0.78%	-1.15%
Soybeans	1,261.25	-0.14%	-2.38%
Coffee	305.55	+3.65%	+6.48%

Crypto	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
Bitcoin	80,952.1797	-0.53%	-2.58%
Ethereum	2,363.22	-1.52%	-5.34%

Investment Banks	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
Goldman Sachs	881.26	-1.12%	-1.57%
Morgan Stanley	180.57	-0.84%	-4.97%
JPMorgan	339.72	+1.25%	+2.02%
Bank of America	51.23	-0.91%	-5.69%
Citigroup	124.26	+0.85%	-4.15%
UBS	47.68	-0.21%	-0.93%
Deutsche Bank	32.57	-0.88%	-3.30%
Barclays	22.79	-0.09%	-0.70%
HSBC	94.57	+0.03%	+1.71%
Santander	13.3	-1.19%	-1.41%
BBVA	25.72	-0.89%	+0.05%
Lazard	36.09	-0.19%	-1.80%
Evercore	254.08	-0.99%	-6.54%
Jefferies	44.8	-0.22%	+0.95%

Asset Managers & Private Equity	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
BlackRock	1,134.38	+1.21%	+4.80%
Blackstone	106.61	-2.37%	-6.72%
KKR	86.21	-1.62%	-5.21%
Apollo	110.78	-0.97%	-6.63%
Carlyle	36.38	-1.17%	-5.31%
Ares Management	112.27	-1.54%	-4.22%
T. Rowe Price	100.97	-0.39%	-3.98%
Franklin Templeton	30.98	-1.27%	-3.19%
Invesco	28.2	-2.08%	-4.44%
3i Group	2,468.0	+0.86%	+2.75%
Schroders	589.0	+0.00%	+0.08%
Amundi	89.0	+0.91%	+0.85%
EQT	298.1	+3.33%	+4.93%

Exchanges & Payments	Last	Day	Week
Intercontinental Exchange	161.56	+1.99%	+3.44%
CME Group	293.87	+1.52%	+4.74%
Nasdaq Inc.	93.97	+0.50%	+0.34%
LSEG	8,768.0	+0.97%	+0.85%
Deutsche Boerse	309.5	+1.31%	+4.56%
Visa	402.61	+0.72%	+4.45%
Mastercard	617.42	+0.18%	+4.80%

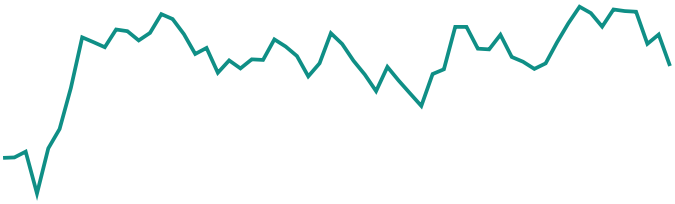
Oil & Gas Majors	Last	Day	Week
ExxonMobil	178.98	+2.46%	+5.94%
Chevron	224.99	+2.59%	+6.14%
Shell	106.66	+3.00%	+6.47%
BP	50.21	+3.65%	+8.56%
TotalEnergies	91.34	+3.22%	+6.07%
ConocoPhillips	146.51	+3.37%	+9.25%
Equinor	46.98	+4.59%	+9.23%
Occidental	62.38	+2.82%	+3.78%
US Oil Fund (ETF)	161.76	+2.83%	+9.15%

Mining & Metals	Last	Day	Week
BHP	83.29	+0.47%	-3.98%
Rio Tinto	90.32	+0.12%	-4.71%
Glencore	583.1	+1.57%	-0.26%
Freeport-McMoRan	69.54	-0.74%	-5.43%
Newmont	118.6	+2.43%	+0.64%
Vale	13.06	+0.31%	-4.11%
Gold Miners (ETF)	87.71	+0.79%	-1.76%

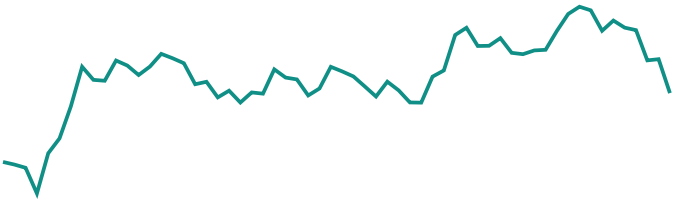
Big Tech & IPO Barometer	Last	Day	Week
Nvidia	214.13	-1.43%	-6.61%
Microsoft	529.05	-1.93%	-1.13%
Apple	343.46	+0.43%	+2.03%
Amazon	250.0	-1.87%	-4.74%
Alphabet	340.59	-2.47%	-3.15%
Meta	709.33	-3.72%	-1.30%
Tesla	354.72	-2.13%	-7.31%
Renaissance IPO (ETF)	48.91	-3.97%	-8.32%

Key charts (last 60 trading days)

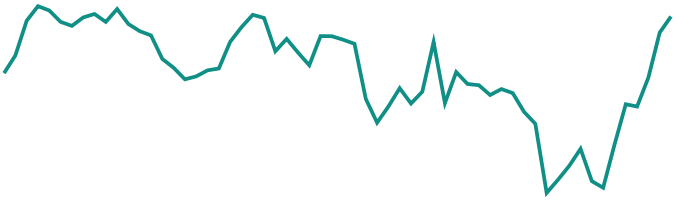
S&P 500: low 7316.15, high 7818.93, last 7659.44



Nasdaq: low 24442.9, high 27599.8, last 26140

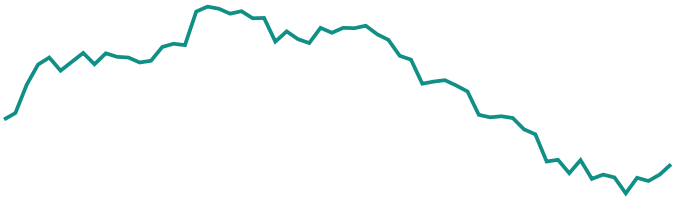


FTSE 100: low 10428.3, high 10908.4, last 10881.9

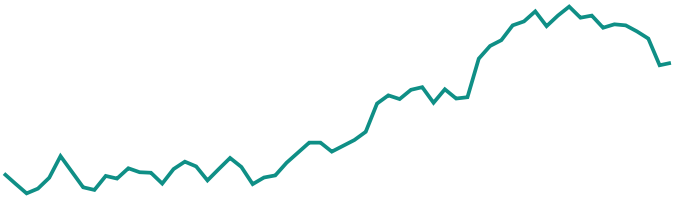


DAX: low 24807, high 26570, last 25622.6

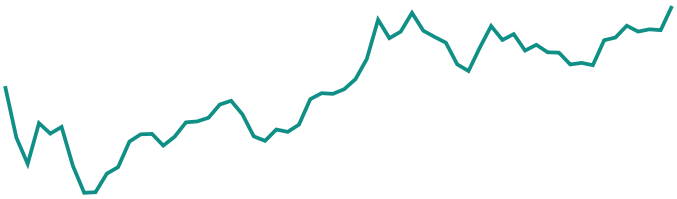
EUR/USD: low 1.116, high 1.1688, last 1.1242



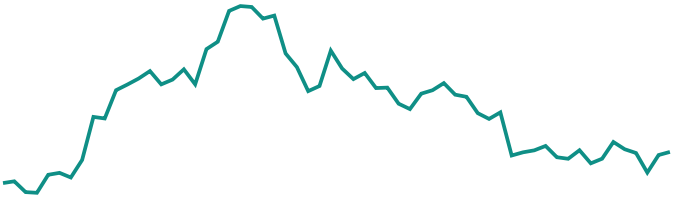
US 10Y yield: low 4.604, high 5.311, last 5.098

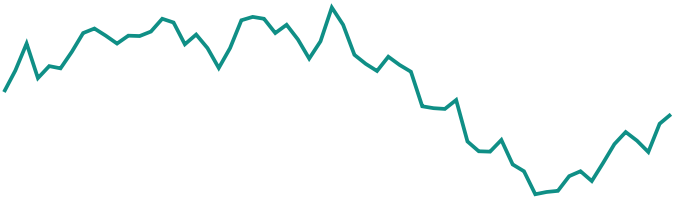


Brent crude: low 79.36, high 109.86, last 109.86



Gold: low 4036.3, high 4697.8, last 4181.1



Bitcoin: low 73032.8, high 86602.9, last 80952.2

US Financials (XLF): low 53.4, high 58.3535, last 55.52